

Girmachew Samson

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EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology

B.S. Computer Science

May 2030

Atlanta, GA

- **Relevant Coursework:** Introduction to Computing (CS 1301), Introduction to Object-Oriented Programming (CS 1331)
- **Awards:** LinkedIn Future Possibilities in Tech Scholarship, Teamsters Scholarship

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Java, HTML/CSS

Frameworks, Libraries & Tools: React.js, Next.js, Node.js, React Native, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap, Supabase, Firebase, Stripe, LiveKit, WebSockets, Vercel, REST APIs, Git, GitHub

Certifications: Claude 101, Claude Code, AI Fluency: Frameworks & Foundations (Anthropic)

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer Intern

Sonaara

Aug. 2025 – Dec. 2025

Atlanta, GA

- Developed and shipped React Native features across the production mobile app serving **600+ users**, **improving load performance by 22%** through lazy loading and component optimization.
- Integrated TruFace API for identity verification, onboarding **90+ verified users** and **reducing auth friction** by replacing manual ID review with automated facial matching.
- Architected and optimized backend database schema to support a real-time messaging feature, enabling direct user-to-user communication and improving session-level retention.

Freelance Web Developer

Self-Employed

Jan. 2024 – Jan. 2026

Tucker, GA

- Designed and delivered **20+ custom websites and web apps** across multiple industries, tailoring each solution to specific client growth goals and business requirements.
- Grew a client's club membership by **10%+** and **increased user engagement by 17%** within one month through data-informed UX redesigns and performance tuning.
- Built responsive, SEO-optimized production sites using HTML, CSS, Tailwind CSS, JavaScript, React.js, Node.js, and REST APIs, averaging **90+ Lighthouse scores**.

PROJECTS

Bantr | *Next.js, TypeScript, LiveKit, Supabase, Stripe, Vercel* | [Link](#)

Feb. 2026 – Present

- Founder and developer of Bantr, a full-stack live debate platform with real-time audio, voting, chat, and reputation tracking, **scaling to 250+ users in open beta**.
- Implemented Redis-backed rate limiting on high-frequency user actions including chat messages, polls, and follow/unfollow requests, preventing spam and abuse across concurrent debate rooms.
- Implemented scheduled cleanup jobs to prune stale and abandoned debate rooms, reducing unnecessary load on active room state and improving platform responsiveness as concurrent rooms scaled.

Transvero | *TypeScript, Firebase, AssemblyAI, WebSockets* | [Link](#) | [GitHub](#)

Sep. 2025 – Mar. 2026

- Built a real-time multilingual transcription and live captioning app for accessibility, placing Top 10 in the Software Development track of a 2026 statewide tech competition.
- Architected a dual speech-to-text pipeline using the AssemblyAI API as the primary transcription engine for higher accuracy and speaker identification, with the Web Speech API as a fallback to maintain captioning continuity if the primary service was unavailable.

ScholarLink | *React, TypeScript, Node.js* | [Link](#) | [GitHub](#)

Sep. 2024 – Present

- Built a scholarship discovery platform connecting students with funding opportunities matched to their goals, **adopted by 75+ students** to find and apply for scholarships, and placed Top 10 in the Webmaster track of a 2026 statewide tech competition.
- Built a save-to-account system backed by Firebase, letting users bookmark scholarships to a persistent list and track application status across sessions.